a field that few women chose. She later pursued advanced studies in England.



Set up in 1664 to treat sick soldiers employed by the East India Company, the Madras Medical College was only opened to Indians in 1842.

Fighting for women's rights

Alongside running a successful practice, Reddy argued for expanding women's rights. In 1926, she became the first female deputy president of the Legislative Council of Madras Presidency. She was also a member of the Women's Indian Association and wrote about and argued publicly on ensuring access to education, healthcare and voting rights for women. She was especially influential in helping to abolish the devadasi system. She also founded the Adyar Cancer Institute in Chennai.

